

The masculinity ratios by five year age groups for the census years from 1946 to 1971 are shown in Table 5.7. It will be noted that in all age groups, the total population of the country shows an excess of males over females in all censuses from 1946 to 1971. However, the sex ratio for all age groups between 10 and 49 years has shown an almost continuous decline while that for the ages above 50 has recorded wide fluctuations. In 1971 the sex ratios for all age groups were very much lower than the corresponding ratios in 1946 except in the ages 50-54 and 60-64.

TABLE 5.7 : SEX RATIO : MALES PER 1000 FEMALES BY FIVE YEAR AGE GROUPS : 1946-1971

Age Group	1946	1953	1963	1971
0 - 4	1032	1015	1026	1032
5 - 9	1031	1026	1020	1028
10 - 14	1060	1066	1047	1042
15 - 19	1153	1074	1028	1026
20 - 24	1045	1061	1006	1013
25 - 29	1137	1099	1020	1008
30 - 34	1212	1212	1123	1073
35 - 39	1260	1200	1107	1023
40 - 44	1304	1304	1217	1156
45 - 49	1347	1329	1253	1135
50 - 54	1148	1348	1275	1189
55 - 59	1383	1367	1371	1222
60 - 64	1201	1208	1348	1282
65 and over	1190	1203	1212	1188
All ages	1130	1115	1082	1061

The sex ratios by districts are shown in Table 5.8. The free and easy movement of people within the country, has caused the sex ratios to vary from district to district. Migration is generally selective of sex and age. It will be seen from the Table that the sex ratios are very high in the district of Colombo, Mannar, Vavuniya, Amparai, Trincomalee, Anuradhapura, Polonnaruwa and Moneragala. As marked in Chapter 4 there have been heavy movement of people into these district in recent years. Since males particularly males at their young productive ages, are more mobile than females, the sex ratio of sending areas tend to be low and that of receiving areas high. The drift of the population from rural to urban areas in recent years has also tended to make the sex ratio higher for urban areas compared to rural areas.

TABLE 5.8 : SEX RATIOS BY DISTRICTS 1971

District	Sex Ratio
Sri Lanka	1061
Colombo	1101
Kalutara	1015
Kandy	1039
Matale	1063
Nuwara Eliya	1041

Contd.